

AI Appointment Scheduler — Standard Operating Procedure

For clinic staff and non-technical operators

Version 6 · July 2026

1. What This Assistant Does

The clinic has an AI chat assistant that handles dental appointments with Dr. Hakim around the clock, without staff involvement. Patients open the chat link and can book a new appointment, or cancel or move an existing one.

To book, a patient gives their name, phone number, and preferred time. The assistant checks that the clinic is actually open then, checks the real calendar for conflicts, offers alternatives if the slot is taken, asks the patient to confirm, and then creates the appointment on the calendar and records it in the clinic spreadsheet.

The assistant only discusses dental appointments. Anything else — jokes, general questions, homework — is politely declined. It also blocks spam automatically and refuses attempts to misuse it.

2. Where Everything Lives

- **The chat:** the public chat link patients use, from the clinic website or shared directly.
- **The calendar:** Google Calendar, 'Dental Appointment'. Every booking appears here, titled with the patient's name and phone number.
- **The spreadsheet:** Google Sheets, 'Demo Dental Clinic'. The Booking tab lists every patient booked and whether it is Confirmed or Cancelled. The Logs tab records every conversation the assistant handled.

3. Daily Routine

1. Each morning, open the **Dental Appointment calendar** and review the day's appointments. Every entry shows the patient's name and phone number in its title.
2. Skim the **Booking tab** for new rows since yesterday. Check each has a name, a phone number, a date, and a status.
3. Anything odd — missing details, a time outside office hours, a row marked Cancelled that is still on the calendar — call the patient on the number shown and correct the calendar by hand.

4. Office Hours the Assistant Enforces

Monday to Friday, 9:00 AM to 8:00 PM. Saturday, 9:00 AM to 1:00 PM. Sunday closed. Consultations last 1 hour with a 15-minute break between patients, so the last appointment starts at 7:00 PM on weekdays and 12:00 noon on Saturday. All times are Philippine time.

These hours are enforced automatically — the assistant cannot book outside them even if a patient insists. If clinic hours change, the administrator must update the assistant. Until then it will keep enforcing the old hours.

5. How the Assistant Protects Itself (Plain Language)

These protections are automatic and need nothing from you. This section explains behavior patients might mention.

- **Spam blocking:** more than 10 messages in half a minute, or the same message repeated, and the assistant asks them to slow down and pauses. Repeat offenders are paused for 15 minutes.
- **Off-topic requests:** questions unrelated to appointments get 'I can only help with dental appointments.' This is intentional and correct.
- **Manipulation attempts:** people sometimes try to trick AI assistants into ignoring their instructions. The assistant recognizes and refuses these.
- **Double-booking prevention:** before booking, the assistant reads the actual calendar for that day and will not book a time that overlaps an existing appointment.
- **Identity checks:** nobody can cancel an appointment unless the phone number they give matches the one on the appointment. The assistant will not cancel by name alone.

6. Cancellations and Changes

A patient can cancel or move an appointment through the chat. The assistant asks for their phone number, finds the appointment, reads the details back, and asks them to confirm. Only then does it remove the appointment from the calendar and mark the spreadsheet row as Cancelled.

Cancelled rows stay in the spreadsheet with the status Cancelled rather than being deleted — you keep the history.

If a patient asks you to cancel on someone else's behalf, the assistant will refuse. Handle those by phone.

7. Common Situations

A patient says the assistant told them to slow down

They triggered spam protection, usually by sending many messages quickly. Ask them to wait 15 minutes and send one message at a time. If urgent, take the booking by phone and add it to the calendar by hand.

A patient says the assistant refused their question

The assistant only handles appointments; if they asked something else, that refusal is correct. If they were genuinely trying to book and were still refused, take the booking manually and note exactly what they typed — pass it to the administrator so the filters can be tuned.

A patient received 'There's an unexpected error, please call [clinic number]'

Something failed behind the scenes. The assistant is designed to say this rather than guess. Take the booking or cancellation by phone, enter it into the calendar yourself, and tell the administrator.

A patient says their appointment was cancelled but it is still on the calendar

Trust the calendar and check the spreadsheet's status column. Call the patient to establish what they intended, correct both by hand, and report it to the administrator.

Two patients appear at the same time slot

Keep the earlier calendar entry. Call the later patient on the number in the event title, apologize, and rebook. Report both entries to the administrator.

The assistant is not replying at all

A technical person should confirm the workflow is Active and the hosting service is running. Until it is restored, take bookings by phone and enter them into the calendar manually.

8. Do's and Don'ts

- **Do** keep taking phone bookings — just always enter them into the same Google Calendar, so the assistant sees them and never books over them.
- **Do** use the phone number in each calendar entry to contact patients about changes.
- **Do** leave cancelled rows in the spreadsheet. The status column is the record.
- **Don't** rename or delete the Booking or Logs tabs, or change their column headings. The assistant writes to them by name and will fail silently.
- **Don't** delete or rename the BookingID column. It is what links each spreadsheet row to its calendar appointment; without it, cancellations cannot be matched.
- **Don't** rename or delete the 'Dental Appointment' calendar.
- **Don't** edit the workflow, its credentials, or the connected Google accounts unless you are the administrator.

9. When to Contact the Administrator

1. The assistant stops replying, or patients report the error message.
2. A double booking occurs.
3. Bookings stop appearing in the calendar or spreadsheet.
4. The calendar and the spreadsheet disagree about an appointment.
5. Clinic hours, consultation length, or the break duration change.
6. Patients report the assistant behaving strangely — screenshot the conversation if possible.